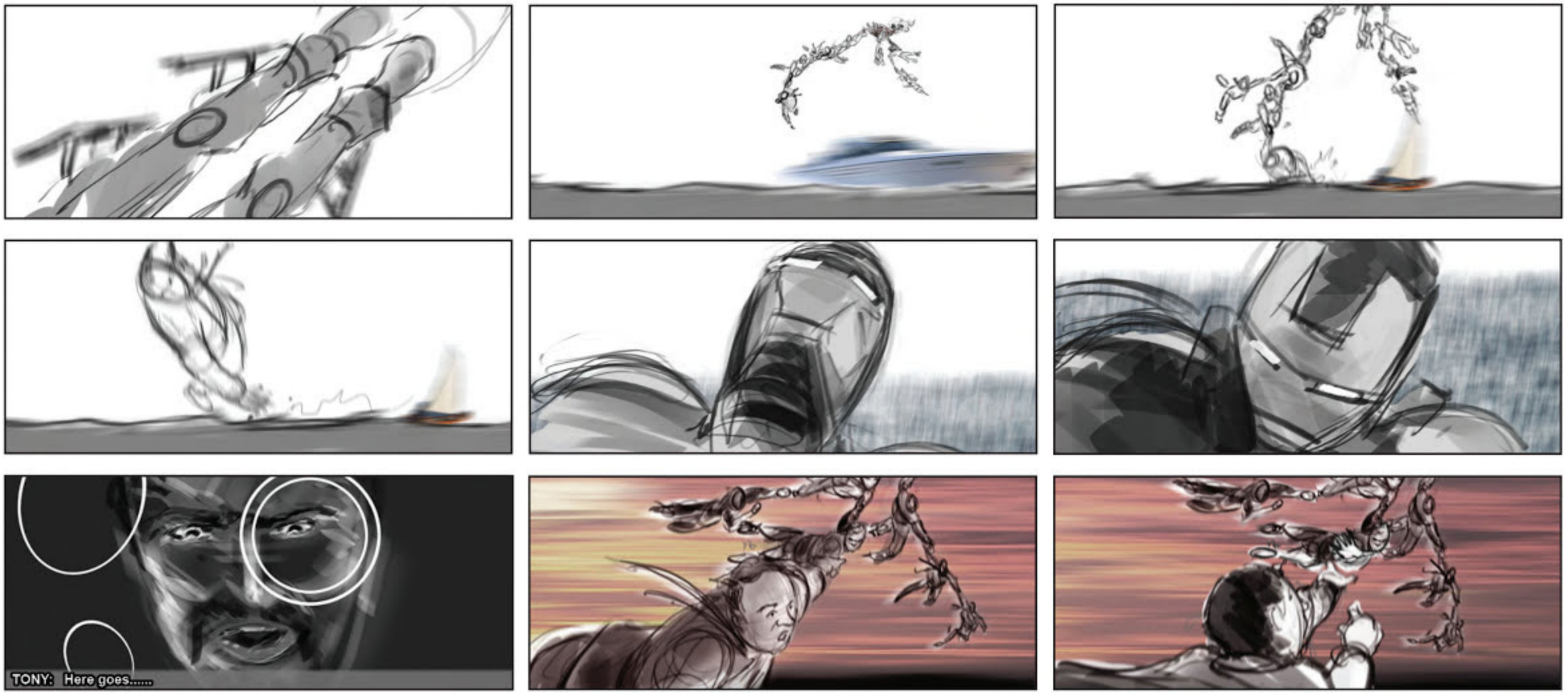
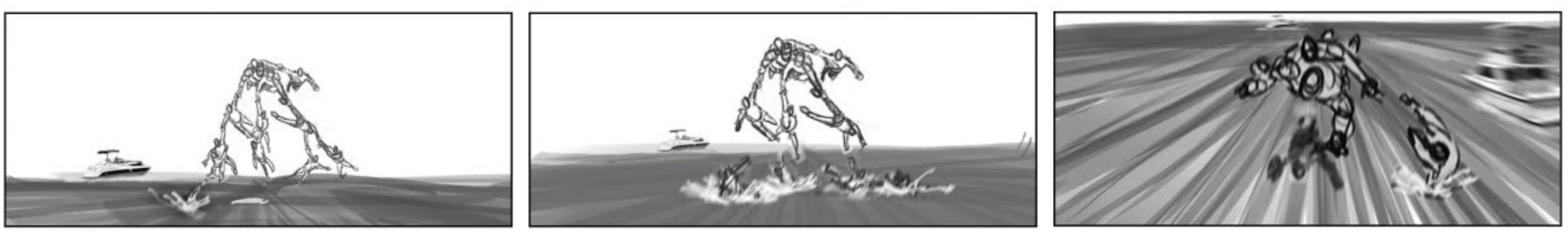




The trickiest part of the shoot was the ending, where Iron Man and his thirteen "monkeys" splash down into the water. "That was really complicated," Smrz says. "A big, big rig with fourteen guys on cables—all having to fly together, hanging in different positions, and moving at the same pace as they were released into the water. But we had enough time to practice it, to slowly build up to it."

Habberstad explains: "The drop was done on a 600-foot zipline. We had fifteen ziplines—one for each of the characters and Iron Man, and another for the camera. And we shot all these people on a 600-foot run, starting about a hundred feet in the air, zipping down and being dropped in the water one at a time.

"There were a lot of details. We had about a thousand pairs of little clear goggles that people could wear, that wouldn't be seen. If the people were going to be close to the camera, they could wear the goggles for the initial part of the jump. Then right before we'd start rolling, they'd take the goggles off and get rid of them.

"We were jumping over the ocean, so everyone had to have emergency flotation gear in case they landed in the ocean. We had to design special, really low-profile flotation gear that could also be easily accessed, because we wouldn't have a whole lot of time to get to it in an emergency.

"We had things like skirts flying up, and the gear had to be attached so the wind wouldn't do that. Girls with high-heeled shoes would take the shoes off after the parachutes were opened and hold them in their hands. The hats pretty much flew off when the plane got blown open, so that wasn't an issue."

Smrz says the sequence was his favorite part of the film "mostly because it was a sequence that was designed, prepped, and executed as it was supposed to be."